CHATGPT IMAGE GENERATION

The Guidebook

Make any image you can describe —
posters, covers, posts and more.

From one sentence in a chat box
to a ready-to-post picture.

SETUP · STYLES · EDITING · 10 TESTED PROMPTS · CHECKLIST

14 pages · By Saurabh Saha · 2026 Edition

START HERE

Describe it — and it draws it

Until now, getting an image meant one of three things: searching stock-photo sites for something close, hiring a designer, or settling for whatever photo your phone could take. ChatGPT's image generation removes all three. You type a sentence describing the picture in your head, and within seconds you are looking at it.

It is not searching the internet for a matching photo. It is **creating a new image** from your words — which means the tea shop in your image can be *your* tea shop, the poster can carry *your* name and date, and the product photo can show *your* product. And if the first version is not right, you do not start over: you simply reply — "make it evening", "move the bicycle left" — and it edits its own picture.



What this guidebook gives you

- **Setup** — account, app and your first image in minutes (pages 3–4).
- **The prompt formula** — the 5-part sentence that gets good images almost every time (page 5).
- **Styles, editing and text** — posters, logos, correct spelling, same character again and again (pages 6–9).
- **10 tested prompts** — copy-ready, for products, posts, covers, thumbnails and greeting cards (pages 10–11).
- **Troubleshooting + one-page checklist** (pages 13–14).

You need only a mobile phone and a free ChatGPT account. Everything is shown mobile-first.

CHAPTER 1

Setup: account, app, first steps

Image generation lives inside the normal ChatGPT app and website — there is no separate “image app” to install.

Get set up

1. Install **ChatGPT** from the Play Store / App Store (publisher: OpenAI), or open **chatgpt.com** in your browser.
2. Sign in or create a free account with your email. Use one account consistently — your chats and images stay saved in it.
3. Open a **new chat**. To make an image, either just type your description (“Draw a…”, “Create an image of…”), or tap the **+ / tools button** and choose **“Create image”** if your app shows it.
4. Wait a few seconds. The image appears inside the chat. Tap it to see it full-screen, download it, or reply to edit it.

Free vs paid — the honest version

- **Free plan:** image generation works, but only a small number of images per day. When you hit the limit, ChatGPT tells you when it resets. Enough to learn everything in this book.
- **ChatGPT Plus (paid):** many more images, faster generation, and higher limits overall. Worth it only if you create images daily for work.
- **Quality is the same model** either way — a paid plan does not make your prompts better. Pages 5–6 of this book do that.
- **Stay in one chat per project.** Edits and follow-ups work best when the image’s chat stays together.

CHAPTER 2

Your first image, step by step

Here is a complete first session. Type the prompt exactly, watch what comes back, then make one small edit — that edit is where the real skill begins.



The three moves

- **Describe** — one clear sentence: subject, place, style. “A red bicycle outside a small tea shop in Assam, morning light, realistic photo.”
- **Look properly** — open the image full-screen. Check hands, text, edges and small details before judging it.
- **Reply to edit** — “Same image, but at sunset.” One change per reply keeps everything else intact.

CHAPTER 3

The prompt formula: 5 parts, in order

Bad images almost always come from vague prompts, not from a weak tool. Build every prompt from these five parts and your results jump immediately:

1. **Subject** — who or what is in the picture. “A young woman in a red saree”, “a steel tiffin box”.
2. **Scene / action** — where, doing what. “standing at a Guwahati bus stop, holding an umbrella”.
3. **Style** — the look. “realistic photo”, “watercolour illustration”, “flat vector poster”, “3D render”. (Page 6 lists styles.)
4. **Details** — light, colours, mood, camera. “golden-hour light, soft shadows, close-up, smiling”.
5. **Format** — shape and use. “vertical poster”, “square post”, “wide banner”. Always end with this.

Watch the difference

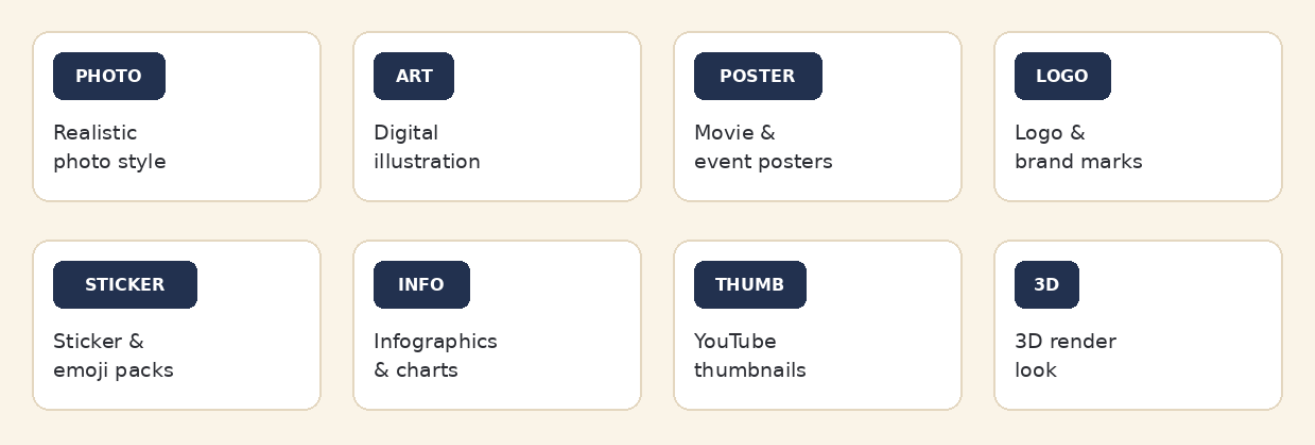
Prompt	Likely result
“a dog”	A random dog, random place, random style. Fine for luck, useless for work.
“A street dog sleeping under a tea-stall bench in the rain, realistic photo, evening light, puddle reflections, vertical poster”	A scene you can almost smell — specific subject, place, light and format, all decided by you.

Rule of thumb: if a stranger could not sketch your prompt roughly the same way twice, add detail until they could.

CHAPTER 3 · CONTINUED

Styles and sizes: say the look, get the look

One style phrase at the end of your prompt changes everything. Keep this page open while you work:



Style words that work reliably

- **Realistic photo** — “photorealistic, shot on a phone camera, natural light” for believable scenes.
- **Illustration** — “flat vector illustration, bold shapes, 3 colours” for posts and covers.
- **Watercolour / sketch** — “soft watercolour painting”, “pencil sketch” for gifts and books.
- **3D / cartoon** — “3D render, Pixar style”, “anime style”, “clay model look” for characters and stickers.
- **Poster** — “cinematic movie poster, dramatic light” when the image must grab attention.

Sizes: just ask in words

- “**Square** image” — Instagram posts, profile pictures.
- “**Wide 16:9** image” — YouTube thumbnails, banners, presentations.
- “**Tall vertical 9:16** image” — reels covers, stories, phone wallpapers, posters.
- If the shape comes out wrong, reply “Make the same image wide 16:9” — do not start a new chat.

CHAPTER 4

Editing: the image is never final

Generation is only half the tool. The other half is editing by conversation — and uploading your own photos to edit. This is where ChatGPT beats most image apps.

Editing a generated image

- **One change per reply:** “Make the sky orange.” Then: “Now remove the bicycle.” Small steps keep the rest of the picture stable.
- **Point with words:** “the man on the left”, “the text at the top” — it understands positions.
- **Regenerate vs edit:** if the whole composition is wrong, ask for a fresh version. If 80% is right, edit — never throw away a good base.
- **Zoom out / expand:** “Show more of the scene around this image” widens a tight crop for banners and covers.

Editing your own photo (upload it in the chat)

- **Change the background:** upload a product photo → “Put this on a clean white studio background, soft shadow.”
- **Remove things:** “Remove the people in the background, keep everything else the same.”
- **Restyle:** “Turn this photo into a watercolour painting / a vintage film photo / a cartoon.”
- **Honest limit:** an edited photo of a real person is a likeness, not a perfect copy — faces can shift slightly. Check before using it anywhere important.

CHAPTER 5

Text in images, posters and logos

Modern ChatGPT is genuinely good at text in images — if you help it. Most spelling failures come from long sentences and unclear wording, not the tool.

The text rules

1. **Keep it short.** A title and 3–4 words beat a paragraph. Long text still breaks; split big designs into two images if needed.
2. **Put the exact words in quotes:** Write the text “SHUBHO BIJOYA” in large gold letters at the top.
3. **Say the language and script:** “in English capital letters”, “in Bengali script” — do not leave it to chance.
4. **Check letter by letter, then fix by reply:** “The word is BIJOYA, not BIJOYO. Fix only the spelling, change nothing else.”
5. **Leave empty space:** “…with clean empty space at the bottom for adding text later” — then add your own text in any editor for 100% correct spelling.

Logos, honestly

ChatGPT is excellent for logo **concepts**: ask for “6 variations of a minimal logo for a tea brand called [name], black on white, flat vector style” and pick directions fast. For a final business logo you will still want the winner redrawn as a true vector file — but as an idea machine, nothing is quicker.

Posters: give it the hierarchy — “Big title at top, date below in smaller text, image of […] filling the middle, venue at the bottom.” Designs come out structured instead of random.

CHAPTER 6

Same character, same product, again and again

The most valuable trick in this book: making the **same** character or product appear in many images — for a story series, a brand, or a page mascot.

Method 1 — the reference image (best)

1. Generate or upload one image you are happy with — this is the **reference**.
2. In the same chat, or a new chat with the image uploaded again, say: “Use the same character from this image. Now show her [new scene]. Keep her face, hair and outfit style the same.”
3. Repeat for every new scene, always starting from the reference image — not from the previous edit, which drifts a little each time.

Method 2 — the fixed description block

Write one exact description and paste it into every prompt: *“Mira, a 22-year-old Assamese girl with long black hair in a side braid, green mekhela chador, small gold earrings.”* Same words, every time. The character stays recognisably herself across dozens of images.

For products: photograph the product once, upload it, and generate new scenes around that photo (“same bottle, now on a wooden table with morning light”). The real photo anchors every version.

Expect 90% consistency, not 100%. Small things — earrings, patterns, fingers — wander. For stories and social media this is plenty; pick the best of two generations.

CHAPTER 7

10 tested prompts — part 1

Copy these exactly, replacing the parts in [brackets]. Each is tested and structured with the 5-part formula from page 5.

1. Product Photo

“Professional product photo of [my product] on a clean white studio background, soft natural shadow, bright even light, realistic photo, square image.”

Selling anything online — shops, WhatsApp catalogues, marketplaces. Upload your product photo first for the real item.

2. Instagram Quote Post

“Minimal flat illustration of [a quiet riverside at dawn], soft pastel colours, large clean empty space at the top for text, square image. Do not add any text.”

Add your quote yourself in an editor — spelling always perfect, design always yours.

3. Book / eBook Cover

“Book cover design, title “ [TITLE] ” in large bold serif letters at the top, author name “[NAME]” at the bottom, background image of [scene], dramatic and clean, vertical poster.”

Self-published books, guidebooks, course PDFs — exactly how this book’s cousins get their covers.

4. YouTube Thumbnail

“Eye-catching YouTube thumbnail: [subject] on the right with a surprised expression, bold background of [colour/scene], big empty space on the left for title text, wide 16:9 image, high contrast.”

Thumbnails get clicks; leave the title space empty and add your text in an editor.

5. Festival Greeting Card

“Festive greeting card for [Durga Puja], illustration of [Maa Durga idol with marigold flowers], warm gold and maroon colours, text “SHUBHO SHARADIYA” in large gold letters at the top, vertical poster.”

Festivals, birthdays, shop greetings — change the festival, idol/scene and greeting text.

CHAPTER 7 · CONTINUED

10 tested prompts — part 2

6. Logo Concepts

“Six variations of a minimal flat logo for a [tea brand] called “[NAME]”, simple shapes, black on white background, no photo effects, arranged in a grid.”

Pick one direction, then ask: “Take variation 3 and make it bolder / rounder / with a leaf.”

7. Sticker Pack

“A sticker sheet of 6 cute cartoon stickers of [a small orange cat]: happy, sleeping, eating, waving, angry, in love. Thick white borders, flat colours, white background.”

Cut them apart in any editor — WhatsApp and Telegram sticker gold.

8. Photo to Illustration

“Turn the uploaded photo into a warm flat illustration, keeping the same people, poses and background layout. Soft colours, clean shapes, no text.”

Profile pictures, gifts, story posts — upload your photo in the chat first.

9. Simple Infographic

“Clean infographic titled “[TITLE]” with 4 sections in a vertical layout, simple icons and short labels: “[A]”, “[B]”, “[C]”, “[D]”. White background, one accent colour [blue], easy to read.”

Keep labels to 2–3 words each or spelling will wander (page 8).

10. Birthday Poster

“Birthday poster for “[NAME]”, turning [age], photo-style illustration of [a cheerful young man] with balloons and a cake, gold confetti, text “HAPPY BIRTHDAY” in large letters at the top, date “[date]” at the bottom, vertical poster.”

Upload the person’s photo and combine with prompt 8’s method for a likeness version.

Make them yours: save your best-performing prompts in a notes app. Within a month you will have a personal library worth more than any list — including this one.

CHAPTER 8

A creator’s weekly workflow

If you post regularly — a shop, a page, a channel — batch your images. One focused hour gives you a week of content, and one chat per project keeps styles consistent.

Step	Time	What to do
Plan	10 min	List the week’s 5–7 posts. Write the plain idea of each image in one line.
Generate	30 min	One chat per project. Generate all base images back to back, using your saved prompt templates (pages 10–11).
Edit & fix	15 min	One change per reply: spelling fixes, crops (“make it square”), background swaps. Download every final image immediately.
Finish	5 min	Add final text (offers, prices, dates) in your editor app — never trust generated text for prices or phone numbers. File images by date.

House rules that save hours

- **Download finals the same day** — chats get buried; your gallery is forever.
- **Keep a “winners” folder** of reference images (page 9) — they anchor your whole visual style.
- **Never publish a first generation.** One edit round is the difference between amateur and professional output.

CHAPTER 9

Troubleshooting: problems and fixes

Problem	Fix
Spelling mistakes in image text	Shorten the text, put exact words in quotes, and fix by reply: “Fix only the spelling to [word], change nothing else.” For prices/numbers, add text yourself in an editor.
Extra fingers, strange hands, odd faces	Regenerate once — hands vary by luck. Or edit: “Fix the hands, keep everything else.” Close-up portraits and simpler poses fail least.
Image looks nothing like my idea	Your prompt was too open. Add the 5 formula parts (page 5) — especially style and format — and remove any words that can mean two things.
It refuses my request	Some requests are blocked by safety rules (real people in misleading scenes, copyrighted characters, violence). Rephrase to an original, harmless version — describe “a cartoon plumber in red” instead of a named character.
Image is soft / low detail	Add “sharp focus, high detail, clean lines” to the prompt, and avoid asking for tiny crowded scenes. Download from the full-screen view, not the chat thumbnail.
“Limit reached” message	Free-plan image limits reset after some hours — the message tells you when. Plan batches (page 12) around it, or use Plus if images are daily work.
The person does not look like the photo	Expected: results are a likeness, not a copy. Use closer, front-facing, well-lit photos, and keep the same reference image for every edit instead of chaining edits.
Download button missing / image stuck	Open the image full-screen and use the download/share icon there. On the website, right-click/long-press → save image. Check your gallery’s Downloads folder.

Golden rule: one problem, one fix, one reply. Changing three things at once makes it impossible to know what helped.

KEEP THIS PAGE

The one-page checklist

One tick per line. Run through it whenever an image matters.

Before generating

- ☐ My prompt has all 5 parts: subject, scene, style, details, format
- ☐ Text in the image is short, quoted exactly, and spelled by me first
- ☐ Right chat opened — same project stays in the same chat

After generating

- ☐ Opened full-screen and checked hands, faces, edges and text
- ☐ Spelling read letter by letter
- ☐ One edit at a time — never three changes in one reply
- ☐ Shape matches where it will be used (square / wide / vertical)
- ☐ Final version downloaded the same day

Series & products

- ☐ Reference image saved and reused for every new scene
- ☐ Character description block pasted word-for-word
- ☐ Real product photo uploaded — not a generated lookalike
- ☐ Prices, dates and phone numbers added by me, not generated

Before publishing

- ☐ Would I believe this image at a glance? Any odd detail fixed?
- ☐ Text 100% correct — my name, my brand, my spelling
- ☐ Image is mine to use: my prompt, my photo, no copied character

That is the whole craft: **describe clearly, check carefully, edit patiently.** Open ChatGPT now and make the image that is already in your head — five minutes from now, it can be on your screen.

— Saurabh Saha

ChatGPT is a product of OpenAI. This guidebook is an independent practical guide, written from hands-on use. Features and limits described are as of the 2026 edition and may change as the app updates.